



# 2024 NATIONAL POPULATION CENSUS FINAL FIGURES



# CENSUS 2024

PAPUA NEW GUINEA  
NATIONAL POPULATION CENSUS



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# Foreword

The 2024 National Population Census Final Figures booklet is a quick and easy way of informing everyone about the population of their own areas. These numbers have been finalized after extensive checking and editing were carried out.

Data collectors visited 30,419 geographical census units to collect the census data. The total persons that were counted during the census period, starting from Sunday 16th June to October 2024 was 10,185,363. This includes the Autonomous Region of Bougainville.

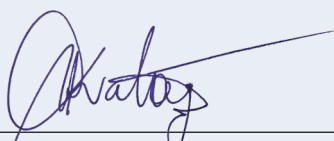
Some findings are;

|                                                             |            |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| PNG Total Population                                        | 10,185,363 |
| PNG Total Male Population                                   | 5,336,546  |
| PNG Total Female Population                                 | 4,848,817  |
| Southern Regional Population                                | 2,320,205  |
| Highlands Regional Population                               | 3,634,114  |
| Momase Regional Population                                  | 2,753,211  |
| Islands Regional Population                                 | 1,477,833  |
| PNG average annual Growth Rate (2011 - 2024)                | 2.6%       |
| Southern Regional average Annual Growth Rate (2011 - 2024)  | 3.6%       |
| Highlands Regional Average Annual Growth Rate (2011 - 2024) | 1.9%       |
| Momase Regional Average Annual Growth Rate (2011 - 2024)    | 3.0%       |
| Islands Regional Average Annual Growth Rate (2011 - 2024)   | 2.3%       |
| PNG Crude Population Density per square kilometre           | 22 persons |

The 2024 Census information is a direct response to rapid growth in the demand for population and demographic data, particularly at lower levels of planning. This has been reinforced by the Organic Law on devolving specific responsibilities from the National Government to the provinces, districts, and local governments; civil registration of citizens; and progressing the electoral reforms.

The NSO is indebted to the Government of Papua New Guinea for the funding of the 2024 National Population Census Project.

October 2025



**John Aseavu Igitoi**  
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# Preface

## 2024 Census Final Figures

This report presents the final figures from the 2024 National Population Census for Papua New Guinea (PNG). Figures for each region, province, and district are included.

Census information in this report represents only a selection of topics from the Census. Detailed demographic information from the 2024 Census will be released progressively. Detailed analytical reports and other products will follow.

The figures in this report show where people were counted at the time of the census. Visitors were included at their location at the time of counting. Census reference night was Sunday 16th June 2024; however, counting extended over to October because of the communication and transport difficulties in doing such a large-scale exercise covering the whole country.

The National Statistical Office (NSO) acknowledges the full support of the government of PNG and UNFPA, the US Census Bureau, as well as many organizations and individuals who contributed to the planning and conduct of the Census. Most of all, we thank the people of PNG for their cooperation and participation in this important national event.



## 1. PAPUA NEW GUINEA OVERVIEW

Papua New Guinea's population has passed the 10 million mark. The 2024 National Population Census counted 10,185,363 people in PNG on Census night.

This represents an increase of 40% (2,910,039 people) in PNG's population count since 2011 (7,275,324)

The average annual growth rate over the past 13 years, since the 2011 Census, was 2.6%.

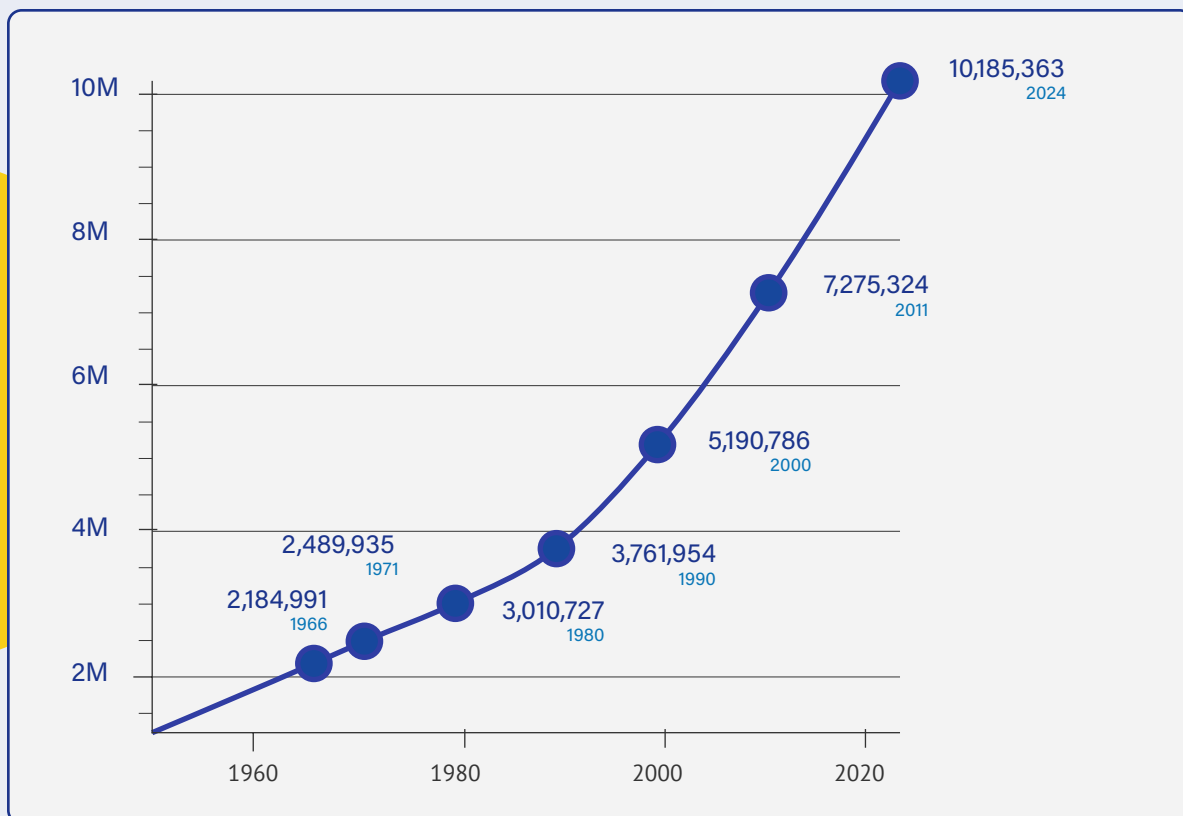
Annual growth rate since the 2011 Census is higher (3.1%) but is likely to be artificially inflated because of non-demographic factors such as higher undercounting in 2000 and improvements to the 2011 and 2024 Census coverage methods.

More males than females were counted in PNG on Census night (52.4% and 47.6% of the total population, respectively). This represents approximately 110 males to every 100 females.

The average number of people per household was 5 for PNG.

Since the first official census in 1980, five years after independence, there have been an additional 7.2 million people added from 3.0 million in the last 44 years

Figure 1: PNG's population growth trend from 1966 to 2024.



## 2. PROVINCIAL OVERVIEW

### Population Size

Of the 22 provinces that make up PNG, Morobe recorded the highest, nearing a million mark, and Eastern Highlands Province with 800,072. Table 1 below shows the population distribution for each province.

Table 1: Population by sex, sex ratio and province, 2024

| Province                              | Persons           | Males            | Females          | Sex Ratio  |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------|------------------|------------------|------------|
| <b>Papua New Guinea</b>               | <b>10,185,363</b> | <b>5,336,546</b> | <b>4,848,817</b> | <b>110</b> |
| 1. Western                            | 300,019           | 156,603          | 143,416          | 109        |
| 2. Gulf                               | 203,545           | 106,948          | 96,597           | 111        |
| 3. Central                            | 373,779           | 198,877          | 174,902          | 114        |
| 4. National Capital District          | 756,754           | 403,291          | 353,463          | 114        |
| 5. Milne Bay                          | 412,158           | 216,985          | 195,173          | 111        |
| 6. Northern                           | 273,950           | 144,626          | 129,324          | 112        |
| 7. Southern Highlands                 | 602,085           | 311,380          | 290,705          | 107        |
| 8. Enga                               | 489,971           | 256,586          | 233,385          | 110        |
| 9. Western Highlands                  | 462,566           | 237,582          | 224,984          | 106        |
| 10. Chimbu                            | 458,406           | 242,663          | 215,743          | 112        |
| 11. Eastern Highlands                 | 800,072           | 417,273          | 382,799          | 109        |
| 12. Hela                              | 365,806           | 194,762          | 171,044          | 114        |
| 13. Jiwaka                            | 455,208           | 237,051          | 218,157          | 109        |
| 14. Morobe                            | 997,545           | 526,505          | 471,040          | 112        |
| 15. Madang                            | 761,154           | 401,885          | 359,269          | 112        |
| 16. East Sepik                        | 631,791           | 321,593          | 310,198          | 104        |
| 17. West Sepik                        | 362,721           | 189,334          | 173,387          | 109        |
| 18. Manus                             | 69,560            | 36,232           | 33,328           | 109        |
| 19. New Ireland                       | 237,780           | 125,634          | 112,146          | 112        |
| 20. East New Britain                  | 434,757           | 226,079          | 208,678          | 108        |
| 21. West New Britain                  | 368,643           | 195,180          | 173,463          | 113        |
| 22. Autonomous Region of Bougainville | 367,093           | 189,477          | 177,616          | 107        |

### Population Distribution by Region

PNG is divided into 4 Regions. The Highlands Region (35.7%) has the highest percentage of PNG's population, followed by Momase (27%), then the Southern and Islands Regions.

### Population Distribution by Province

At the provincial level, Morobe has the highest percentage (9.8%), followed by Eastern Highlands Province (7.9%), Madang (7.5%) and National Capital District (7.4%).

## Sex Ratio

The sex ratio recorded at the national level (more males than females) was reflected in each province. Males outnumbered females in all provinces with the National Capital District, Central and Hela recording the highest sex ratio of 114 males for every 100 females. West New Britain has a sex ratio of 113. The sex ratio in all other provinces varied between 104 (East Sepik) and 112 (Northern, Chimbu, Morobe, and Madang)

## Provincial Growth Rates

The fastest growing provinces (between 2011 and 2024) were Western, National Capital District, Milne Bay, and Madang, each recording more than 3% average annual growth rate since 2011.

Table 2: Provincial population growth rates (2011-2024)

| Province                             | 2011    | 2024    | Growth rate (%) |
|--------------------------------------|---------|---------|-----------------|
| 01 Western                           | 201,351 | 300,019 | 3.1             |
| 02 Gulf                              | 158,197 | 203,545 | 2.0             |
| 03 Central                           | 269,756 | 373,779 | 2.5             |
| 04 National Capital District         | 364,125 | 756,754 | 5.7             |
| 05 Milne Bay                         | 276,512 | 412,158 | 3.1             |
| 06 Northern                          | 186,309 | 273,950 | 3.0             |
| 07 Southern Highlands                | 510,245 | 602,085 | 1.3             |
| 08 Enga                              | 432,045 | 489,971 | 1.0             |
| 09 Western Highlands                 | 362,850 | 462,566 | 1.9             |
| 10 Chimbu                            | 376,473 | 458,406 | 1.5             |
| 11 Eastern Highlands                 | 579,825 | 800,072 | 2.5             |
| 12 Hela                              | 249,449 | 365,806 | 3.0             |
| 13 Jiwaka                            | 343,987 | 455,208 | 2.2             |
| 14 Morobe                            | 674,810 | 997,545 | 3.0             |
| 15 Madang                            | 493,906 | 761,154 | 3.4             |
| 16 East Sepik                        | 450,530 | 631,791 | 2.6             |
| 17 West Sepik                        | 248,411 | 362,721 | 2.9             |
| 18 Manus                             | 60,485  | 69,560  | 1.1             |
| 19 New Ireland                       | 194,067 | 237,780 | 1.6             |
| 20 East New Britain                  | 328,369 | 434,757 | 2.2             |
| 21 West New Britain                  | 264,264 | 368,643 | 2.6             |
| 22 Autonomous Region of Bougainville | 249,358 | 367,093 | 3.0             |



### **3. PROVINCIAL SNAPSHOTS**

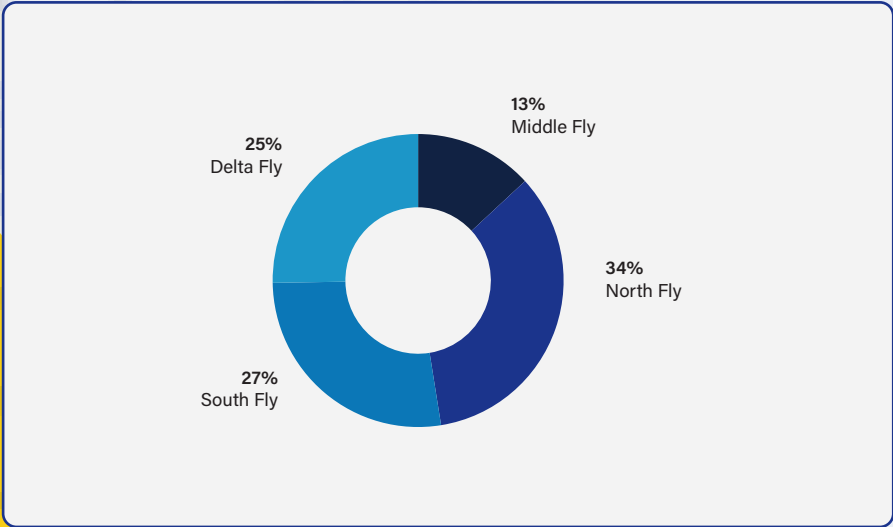
# 01. WESTERN PROVINCE

Population in brief

|                  |         |         |
|------------------|---------|---------|
| Total population | Males   | Females |
| 300,019          | 156,603 | 143,416 |

|                                                   |           |
|---------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Proportion of PNG’s total population              | 2.9%      |
| Annual growth rate since 2011 census              | 3.1%      |
| Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)                 | 109       |
| Population density (persons per km <sup>2</sup> ) | 3         |
| District with highest population count            | North Fly |

## Population Distribution by District



| Districts  | Total   | Male   | Female |
|------------|---------|--------|--------|
| Middle Fly | 39,676  | 20,516 | 19,160 |
| North Fly  | 102,633 | 53,839 | 48,794 |
| South Fly  | 81,613  | 42,696 | 38,917 |
| Delta Fly  | 76,097  | 39,552 | 36,545 |

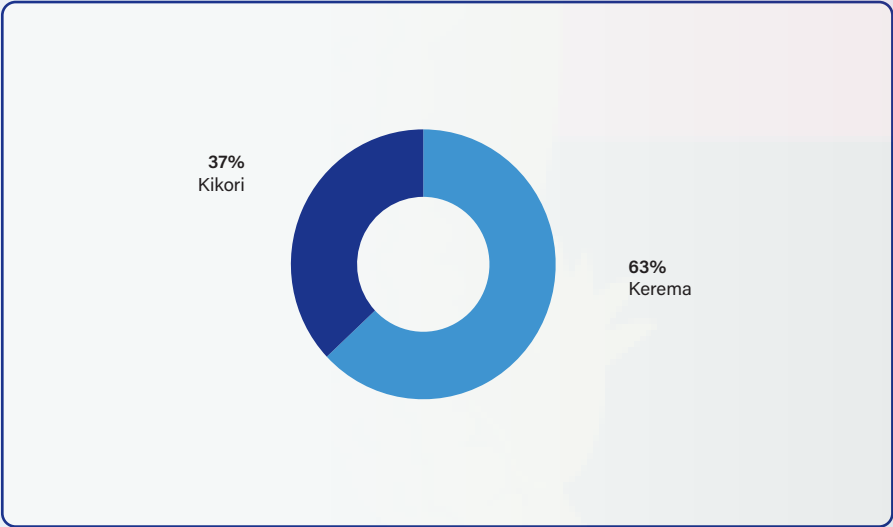
## 02. GULF PROVINCE

Population in brief

|                  |         |        |
|------------------|---------|--------|
| Total Population | Male    | Female |
| 203,545          | 106,948 | 96,597 |

|                                                   |        |
|---------------------------------------------------|--------|
| Proportion of PNG's total population              | 2.0%   |
| Annual growth rate since 2011 census              | 2.0%   |
| Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)                 | 111    |
| Population density (persons per km <sup>2</sup> ) | 6      |
| District with highest population count            | Kerema |

### Population Distribution by District



| Districts | Total   | Male   | Female |
|-----------|---------|--------|--------|
| Kerema    | 127,265 | 67,255 | 60,010 |
| Kikori    | 76,280  | 39,693 | 36,587 |

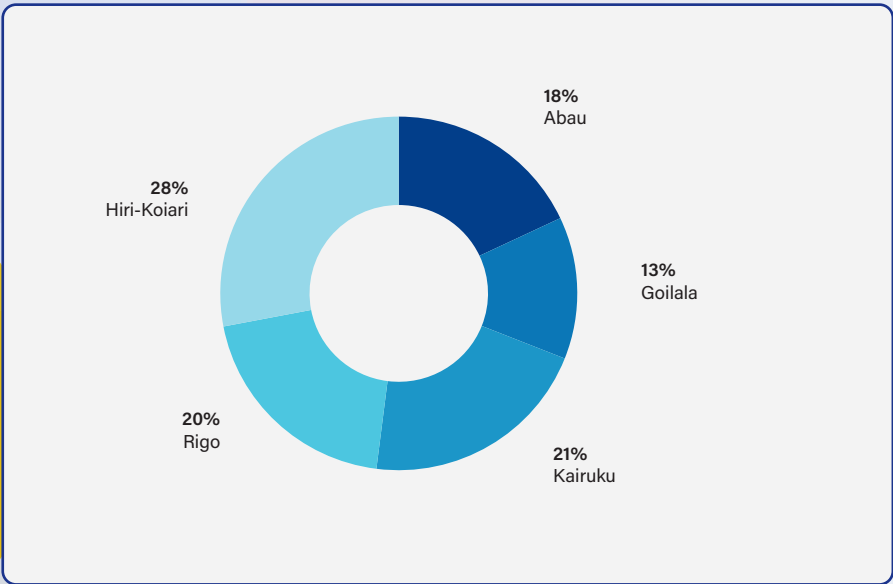
# 03. CENTRAL PROVINCE

Population in brief

|                  |         |         |
|------------------|---------|---------|
| Total Population | Male    | Female  |
| 373,779          | 198,877 | 174,902 |

|                                        |             |
|----------------------------------------|-------------|
| Proportion of PNG’s total population   | 3.7%        |
| Annual growth rate since 2011 census   | 2.5%        |
| Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)      | 114         |
| Population density (person per km²)    | 13          |
| District with highest population count | Hiri-Koiari |

## Population Distribution by District



| Districts   | Total   | Male   | Female |
|-------------|---------|--------|--------|
| Abau        | 68,112  | 36,321 | 31,791 |
| Goilala     | 47,478  | 25,351 | 22,127 |
| Kairuku     | 77,035  | 40,847 | 36,188 |
| Rigo        | 74,935  | 39,685 | 35,250 |
| Hiri-Koiari | 106,219 | 56,673 | 49,546 |



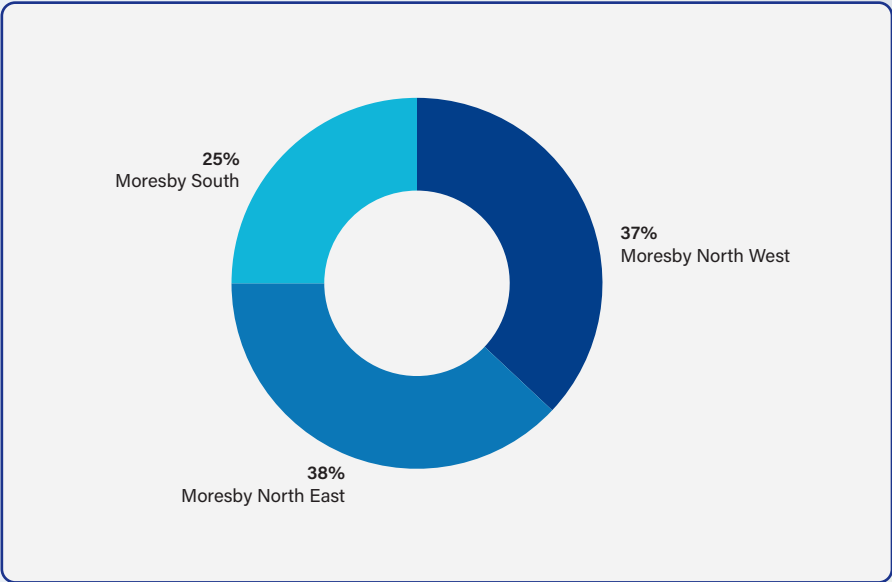
# 04. NATIONAL CAPITAL DISTRICT

Population in brief

|                  |         |         |
|------------------|---------|---------|
| Total Population | Male    | Female  |
| 756,754          | 403,291 | 353,463 |

|                                                  |                    |
|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Proportion of PNG's total population             | 7.4%               |
| Annual growth rate since 2011 census             | 5.7%               |
| Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)                | 114                |
| Population density (person per km <sup>2</sup> ) | 2,653              |
| District with highest population count           | Moresby North East |

## Population Distribution by District



| Districts          | Total   | Male    | Female  |
|--------------------|---------|---------|---------|
| Moresby North West | 282,181 | 149,166 | 133,015 |
| Moresby North East | 285,227 | 153,077 | 132,150 |
| Moresby South      | 189,346 | 101,048 | 88,298  |

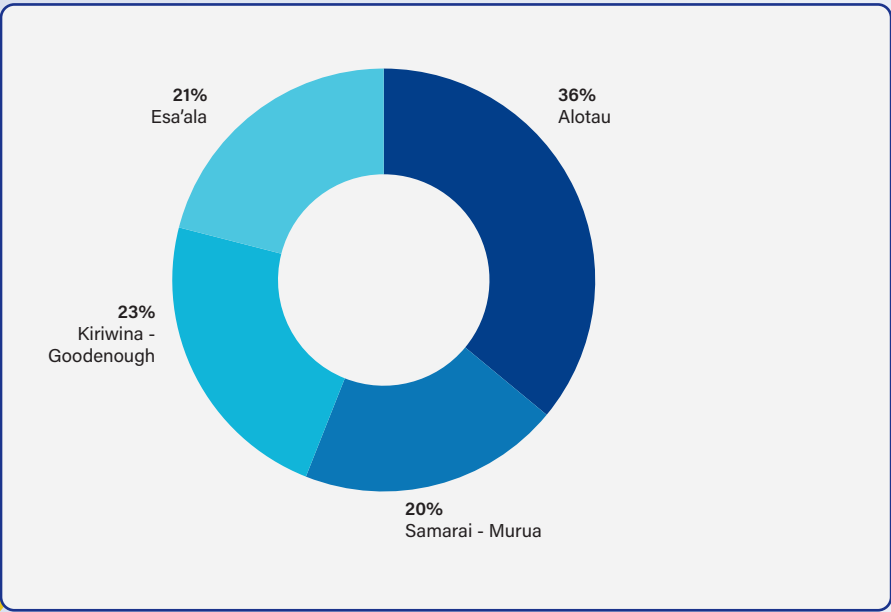
# 05. MILNE BAY PROVINCE

## Population in brief

|                  |         |         |
|------------------|---------|---------|
| Total Population | Male    | Female  |
| 412,158          | 216,985 | 195,173 |

|                                        |        |
|----------------------------------------|--------|
| Proportion of PNG’s total population   | 4.0%   |
| Annual growth rate since 2011 census   | 3.1%   |
| Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)      | 111    |
| Population density (persons per km²)   | 29     |
| District with highest population count | Alotau |

## Population Distribution by District



| Districts           | Total   | Male   | Female |
|---------------------|---------|--------|--------|
| Alotau              | 149,806 | 79,618 | 70,188 |
| Samarai-Murua       | 82,930  | 43,679 | 39,251 |
| Kiriwina-Goodenough | 94,002  | 48,759 | 45,243 |
| Esa'ala             | 85,420  | 44,929 | 40,491 |

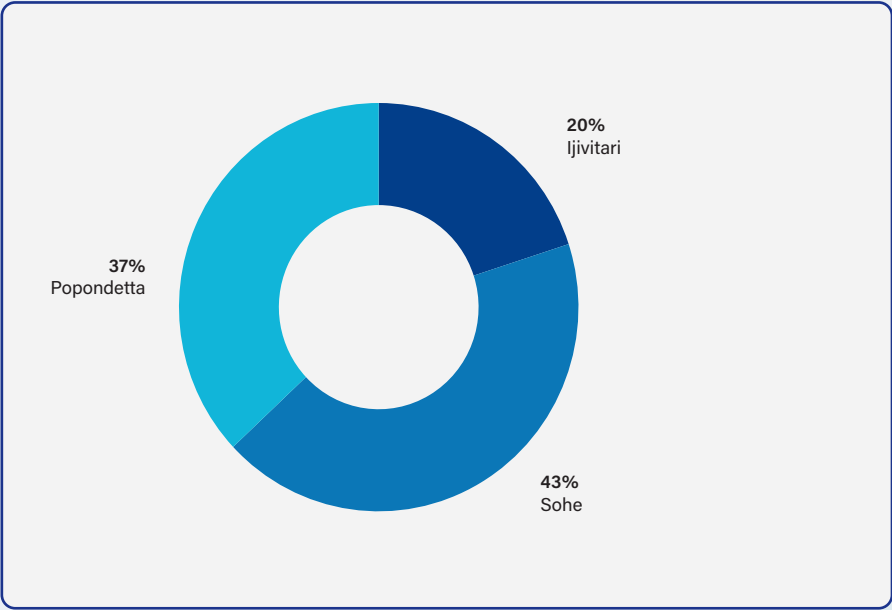
# 06. NORTHERN PROVINCE

Population in brief

|                  |         |         |
|------------------|---------|---------|
| Total Population | Male    | Female  |
| 273,950          | 144,626 | 129,324 |

|                                        |      |
|----------------------------------------|------|
| Proportion of PNG's total population   | 2.7% |
| Annual growth rate since 2011 census   | 3.0% |
| Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)      | 112  |
| Population density (persons per km²)   | 12   |
| District with highest population count | Sohe |

## Population Distribution by District



| Districts  | Total   | Male   | Female |
|------------|---------|--------|--------|
| Ijivitari  | 55,198  | 29,240 | 25,958 |
| Sohe       | 118,109 | 62,096 | 56,013 |
| Popondetta | 100,643 | 53,290 | 47,353 |

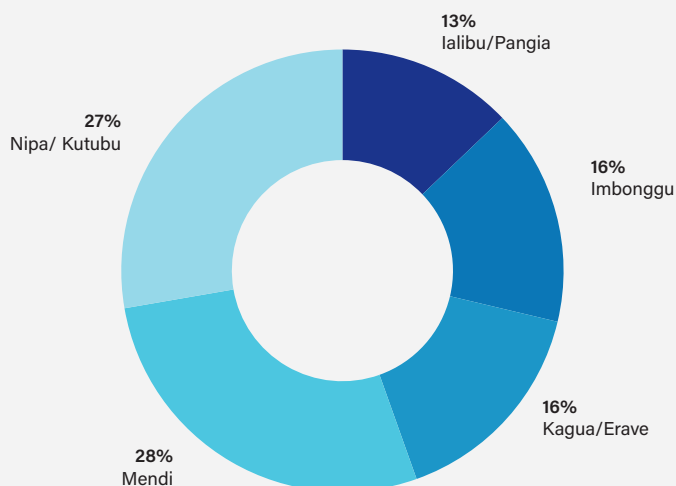
## 07. SOUTHERN HIGHLANDS PROVINCE

### Population in brief

|                  |                |                |
|------------------|----------------|----------------|
| Total Population | Male           | Female         |
| <b>602,085</b>   | <b>311,380</b> | <b>290,705</b> |

|                                                   |       |
|---------------------------------------------------|-------|
| Proportion of PNG's total population              | 5.9%  |
| Annual growth rate since 2011 census              | 1.3%  |
| Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)                 | 107   |
| Population density (persons per km <sup>2</sup> ) | 41    |
| District with highest population count            | Mendi |

### Population Distribution by District



| Districts     | Total   | Male   | Female |
|---------------|---------|--------|--------|
| Ialibu/Pangia | 78,409  | 40,573 | 37,836 |
| Imbonggu      | 94,437  | 48,195 | 46,242 |
| Kagua/Erave   | 96,521  | 50,626 | 45,895 |
| Mendi         | 167,052 | 86,837 | 80,215 |
| Nipa/Kutubu   | 165,666 | 85,149 | 80,517 |

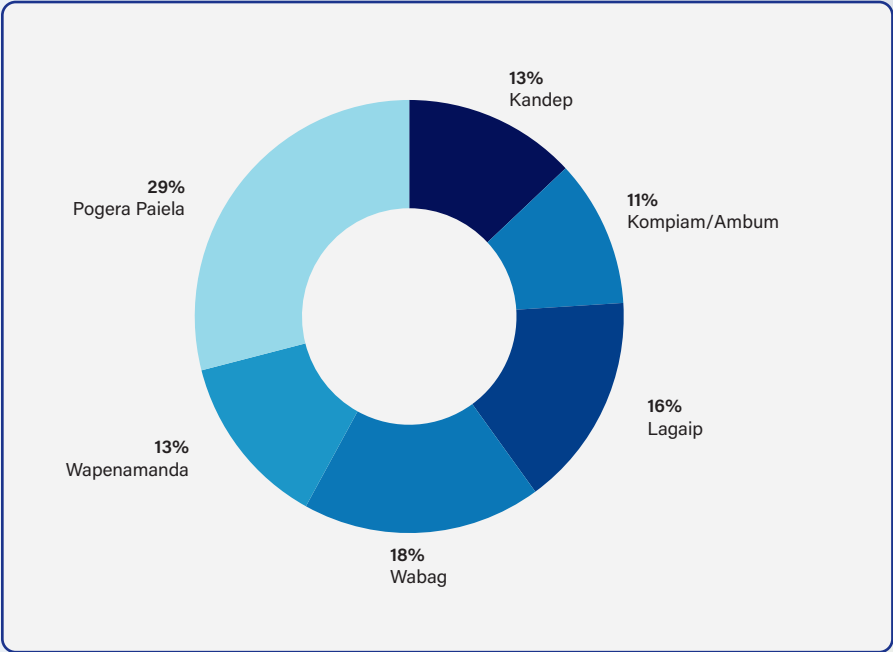
# 08. ENGA PROVINCE

## Population in brief

|                  |         |         |
|------------------|---------|---------|
| Total Population | Male    | Female  |
| 489,971          | 256,586 | 233,385 |

|                                        |               |
|----------------------------------------|---------------|
| Proportion of PNG's total population   | 4.8%          |
| Annual growth rate since 2011 census   | 1.0%          |
| Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)      | 110           |
| Population density (persons per km²)   | 42            |
| District with highest population count | Pogera Paiela |

## Population Distribution by District



| Districts     | Total   | Male   | Female |
|---------------|---------|--------|--------|
| Kandep        | 64,425  | 32,887 | 31,538 |
| Kompiam/Ambum | 51,978  | 26,843 | 25,135 |
| Lagaip        | 76,203  | 40,007 | 36,196 |
| Wabag         | 88,237  | 45,398 | 42,839 |
| Wapenamanda   | 65,527  | 33,334 | 32,193 |
| Pogera Paiela | 143,601 | 78,117 | 65,484 |

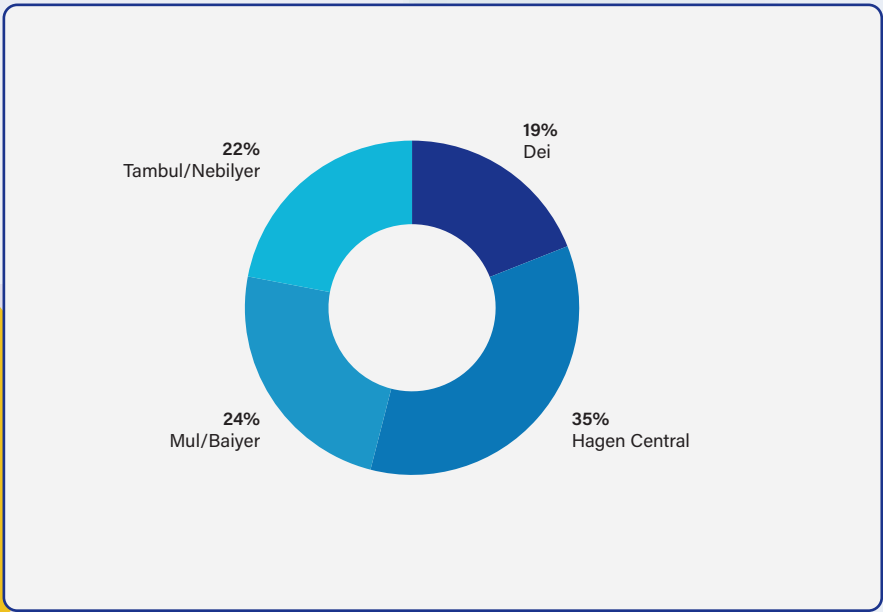
# 09. WESTERN HIGHLANDS PROVINCE

## Population in brief

|                  |         |         |
|------------------|---------|---------|
| Total Population | Male    | Female  |
| 462,566          | 237,582 | 224,984 |

|                                        |               |
|----------------------------------------|---------------|
| Proportion of PNG's total population   | 4.5%          |
| Annual growth rate since 2011 census   | 1.9%          |
| Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)      | 106           |
| Population density (persons per km²)   | 109           |
| District with highest population count | Hagen Central |

## Population Distribution by District



| Districts       | Total   | Male   | Female |
|-----------------|---------|--------|--------|
| Dei             | 91,051  | 46,490 | 44,561 |
| Hagen Central   | 160,914 | 84,205 | 76,709 |
| Mul/Baiyer      | 110,252 | 55,920 | 54,332 |
| Tambul/Nebilyer | 100,349 | 50,967 | 49,382 |



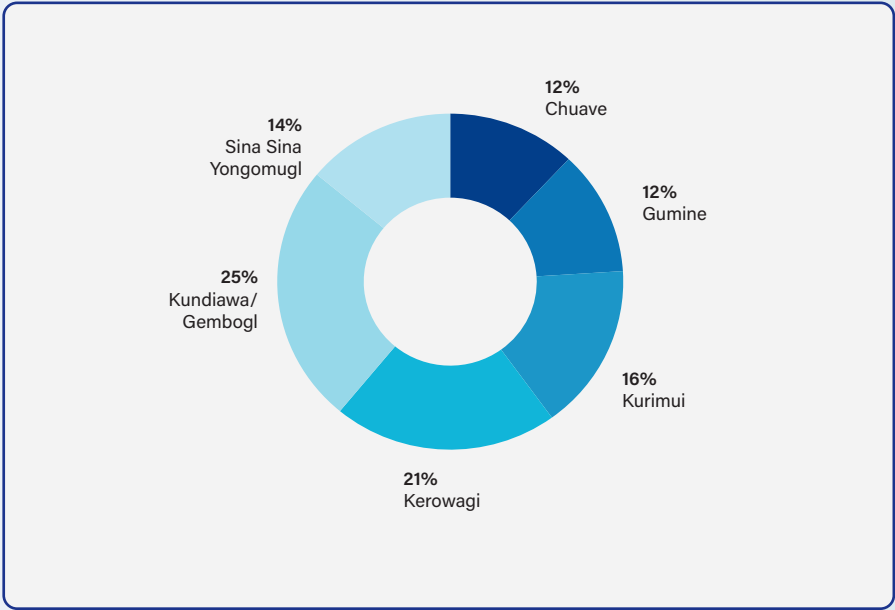
# 10. CHIMBU PROVINCE

Population in brief.

|                  |         |         |
|------------------|---------|---------|
| Total Population | Male    | Female  |
| 458,406          | 242,663 | 215,743 |

|                                        |                  |
|----------------------------------------|------------------|
| Proportion of PNG’s total population   | 4.5%             |
| Annual growth rate since 2011 census   | 1.5%             |
| Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)      | 112              |
| Population density (persons per km²)   | 75               |
| District with highest population count | Kundiawa/Gembogl |

## Population Distribution by District



| Districts           | Total   | Male   | Female |
|---------------------|---------|--------|--------|
| Chuave              | 55,214  | 28,879 | 26,335 |
| Gumine              | 55,207  | 29,315 | 25,892 |
| Karimui             | 72,319  | 38,645 | 33,674 |
| Kerowagi            | 95,690  | 50,915 | 44,775 |
| Kundiawa/Gembogl    | 112,921 | 59,515 | 53,406 |
| Sina Sina Yongomugl | 67,055  | 35,394 | 31,661 |

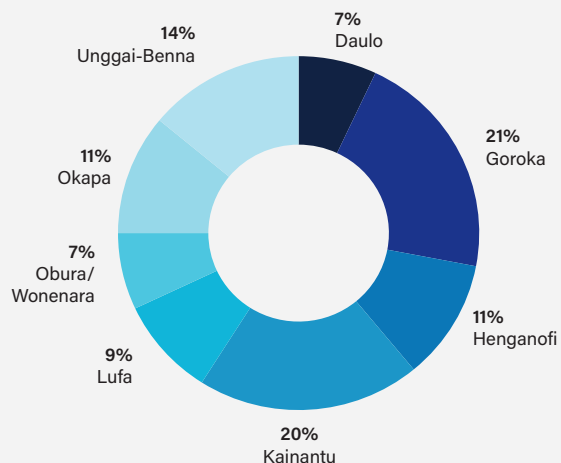
# 11. EASTERN HIGHLANDS PROVINCE

## Population in brief

|                  |                |                |
|------------------|----------------|----------------|
| Total Population | Male           | Female         |
| <b>800,072</b>   | <b>417,273</b> | <b>382,799</b> |

|                                                   |        |
|---------------------------------------------------|--------|
| Proportion of PNG's total population              | 7.9%   |
| Annual growth rate since 2011 census              | 2.5%   |
| Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)                 | 109    |
| Population density (persons per km <sup>2</sup> ) | 72     |
| District with highest population count            | Goroka |

## Population Distribution by District



| Districts      | Total   | Male   | Female |
|----------------|---------|--------|--------|
| Daulo          | 58,789  | 31,211 | 27,578 |
| Goroka         | 163,401 | 85,262 | 78,139 |
| Henganofi      | 85,800  | 44,615 | 41,185 |
| Kainantu       | 162,338 | 84,751 | 77,587 |
| Lufa           | 70,359  | 36,540 | 33,819 |
| Obura/Wonenara | 57,974  | 29,975 | 27,999 |
| Okapa          | 91,145  | 47,313 | 43,832 |
| Unggai-Benna   | 110,266 | 57,606 | 52,660 |

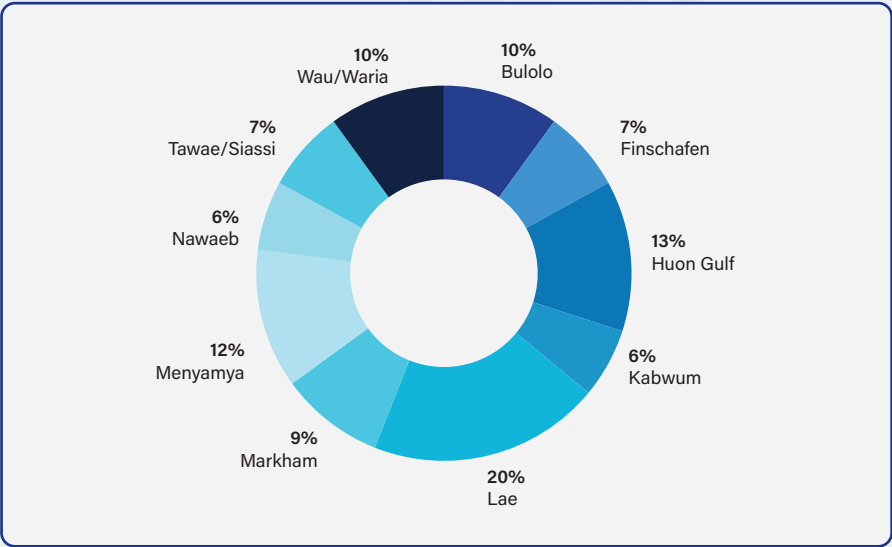
# 12. MOROBE PROVINCE

## Population in brief

|                  |         |         |
|------------------|---------|---------|
| Total Population | Male    | Female  |
| 997,545          | 526,505 | 471,040 |

|                                        |      |
|----------------------------------------|------|
| Proportion of PNG's total population   | 9.8% |
| Annual growth rate since 2011 census   | 3.0% |
| Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)      | 112  |
| Population density (persons per km²)   | 30   |
| District with highest population count | Lae  |

## Population Distribution by District



| Districts    | Total   | Male    | Female |
|--------------|---------|---------|--------|
| Bulolo       | 95,760  | 50,835  | 44,925 |
| Finschafen   | 73,629  | 38,392  | 35,237 |
| Huon Gulf    | 124,505 | 66,166  | 58,339 |
| Kabwum       | 55,423  | 27,811  | 27,612 |
| Lae          | 203,056 | 109,173 | 93,883 |
| Markham      | 93,917  | 48,950  | 44,967 |
| Menyamya     | 119,809 | 61,976  | 57,833 |
| Nawae        | 57,372  | 30,509  | 26,863 |
| Tawae/Siassi | 73,452  | 38,525  | 34,927 |
| Wau/Waria    | 100,622 | 54,168  | 46,454 |

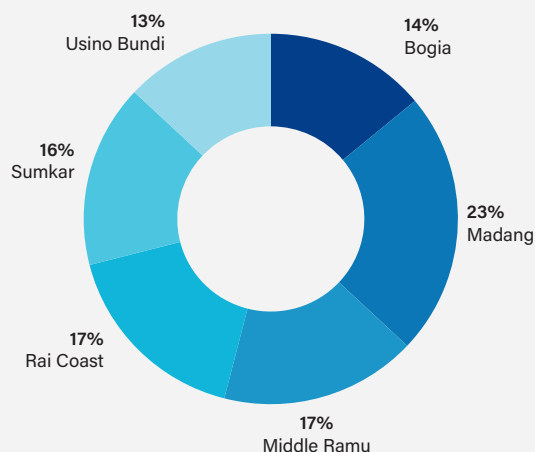
# 13. MADANG PROVINCE

Population in brief.

|                  |                |                |
|------------------|----------------|----------------|
| Total Population | Male           | Female         |
| <b>761,154</b>   | <b>401,885</b> | <b>359,269</b> |

|                                                   |        |
|---------------------------------------------------|--------|
| Proportion of PNG's total population              | 7.5%   |
| Annual growth rate since 2011 census              | 3.4%   |
| Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)                 | 112    |
| Population density (persons per km <sup>2</sup> ) | 26     |
| District with highest population count            | Madang |

## Population Distribution by District



| Districts            | Total   | Male   | Female |
|----------------------|---------|--------|--------|
| Bogia                | 106,780 | 56,294 | 50,486 |
| Madang               | 175,289 | 92,169 | 83,120 |
| Middle Ramu          | 131,610 | 68,427 | 63,183 |
| Rai Coast            | 127,949 | 68,305 | 59,644 |
| Sumkar District      | 121,254 | 64,284 | 56,970 |
| Usino Bundi District | 98,272  | 52,406 | 45,866 |

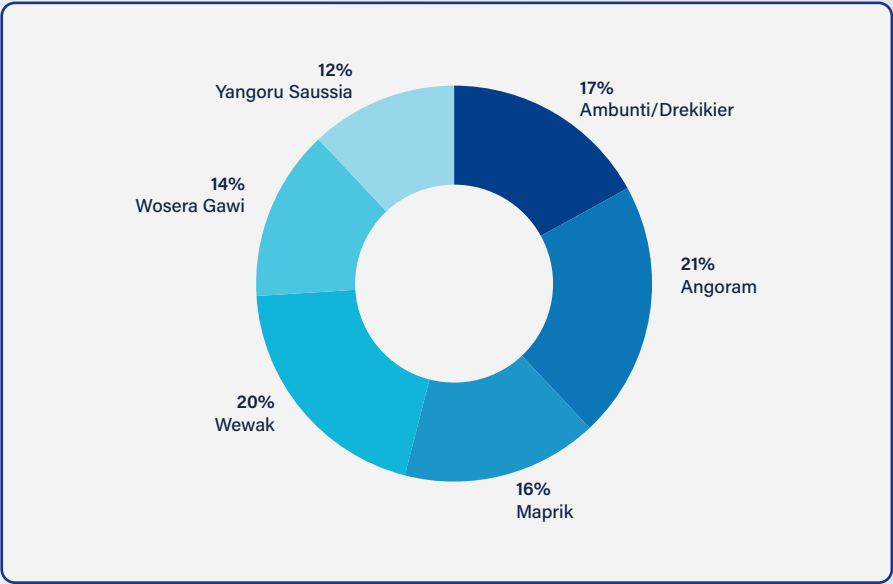
# 14. EAST SEPIK PROVINCE

Population in brief.

|                  |         |         |
|------------------|---------|---------|
| Total Population | Male    | Female  |
| 631,791          | 321,593 | 310,198 |

|                                        |         |
|----------------------------------------|---------|
| Proportion of PNG’s total population   | 6.2%    |
| Annual growth rate since 2011 census   | 2.6%    |
| Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)      | 104     |
| Population density (persons per km²)   | 15      |
| District with highest population count | Angoram |

## Population Distribution by District



| Districts         | Total   | Male   | Female |
|-------------------|---------|--------|--------|
| Ambunti/Drekikier | 109,593 | 56,461 | 53,132 |
| Angoram           | 133,211 | 69,261 | 63,950 |
| Maprik            | 100,367 | 50,472 | 49,895 |
| Wewak             | 123,329 | 61,964 | 61,365 |
| Wosera Gawi       | 90,203  | 45,931 | 44,272 |
| Yangoru Saussia   | 75,088  | 37,504 | 37,584 |

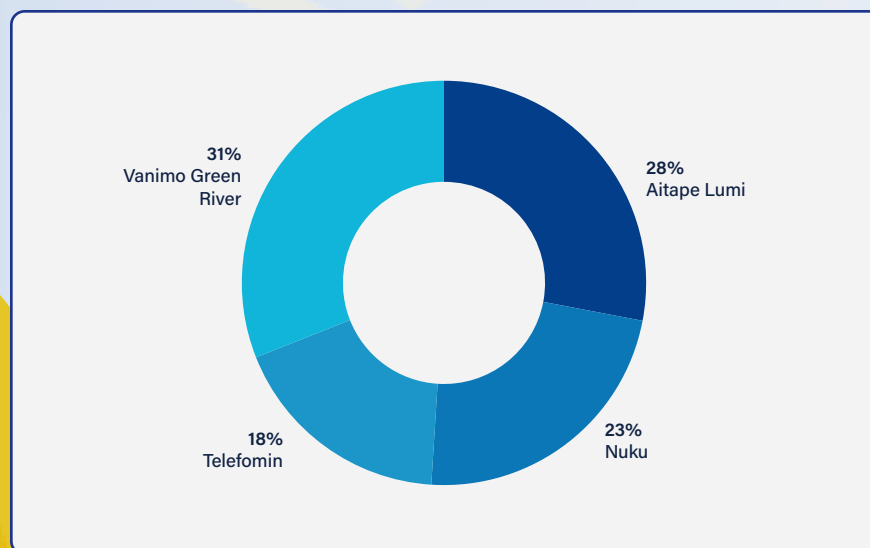
# 15. WEST SEPIK PROVINCE

## Population in brief

|                  |                |                |
|------------------|----------------|----------------|
| Total Population | Male           | Female         |
| <b>362,721</b>   | <b>189,334</b> | <b>173,387</b> |

|                                                   |                    |
|---------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Proportion of PNG's total population              | 3.6%               |
| Annual growth rate since 2011 census              | 2.9%               |
| Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)                 | 109                |
| Population density (persons per km <sup>2</sup> ) | 10                 |
| District with highest population count            | Vanimo Green River |

## Population Distribution by District



| Districts          | Total   | Male   | Female |
|--------------------|---------|--------|--------|
| Aitape Lumi        | 103,360 | 53,758 | 49,602 |
| Nuku               | 83,568  | 43,094 | 40,474 |
| Telefomin          | 63,479  | 32,945 | 30,534 |
| Vanimo Green River | 112,314 | 59,537 | 52,777 |

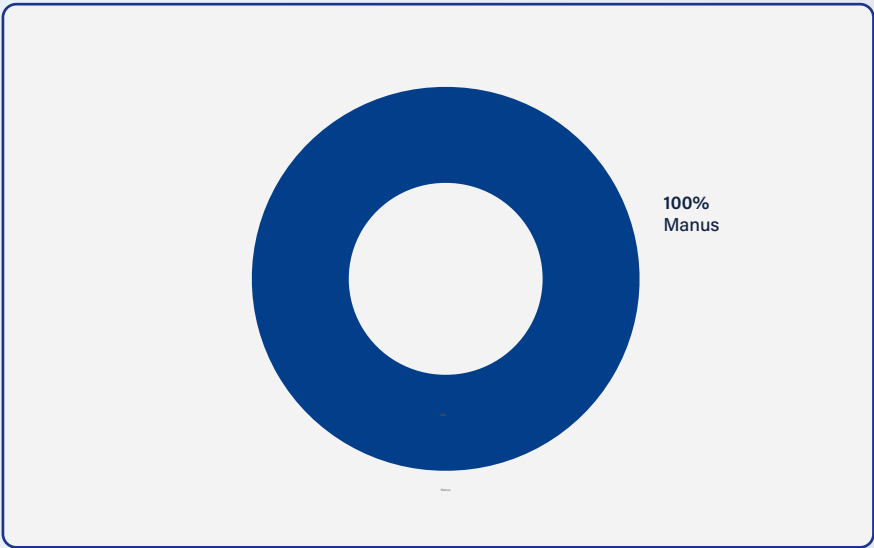
# 16. MANUS PROVINCE

Population in brief.

|                  |        |        |
|------------------|--------|--------|
| Total Population | Male   | Female |
| 69,560           | 36,232 | 33,328 |

|                                        |       |
|----------------------------------------|-------|
| Proportion of PNG's total population   | 0.7%  |
| Annual growth rate since 2011 census   | 1.1%  |
| Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)      | 109   |
| Population density (persons per km²)   | 33    |
| District with highest population count | Manus |

## Population Distribution by District



| Districts | Total  | Male   | Female |
|-----------|--------|--------|--------|
| Manus     | 69,560 | 36,232 | 33,328 |

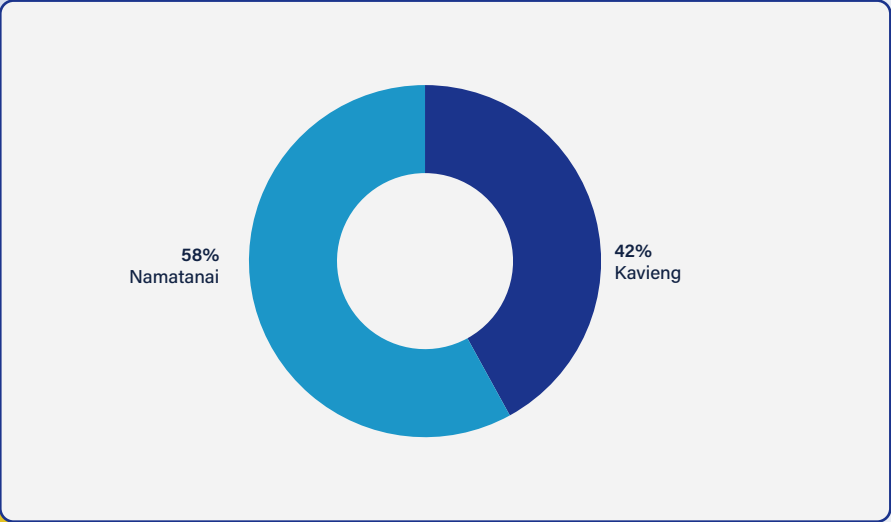
# 17. NEW IRELAND PROVINCE

Population in brief

|                  |         |         |
|------------------|---------|---------|
| Total Population | Male    | Female  |
| 237,780          | 125,634 | 112,146 |

|                                                   |           |
|---------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Proportion of PNG's total population              | 2.3%      |
| Annual growth rate since 2011 census              | 1.6%      |
| Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)                 | 112       |
| Population density (persons per km <sup>2</sup> ) | 25        |
| District with highest population count            | Namatanai |

## Population Distribution by District



| Districts | Total   | Male   | Female |
|-----------|---------|--------|--------|
| Kavieng   | 99,625  | 52,753 | 46,872 |
| Namatanai | 138,155 | 72,881 | 65,274 |



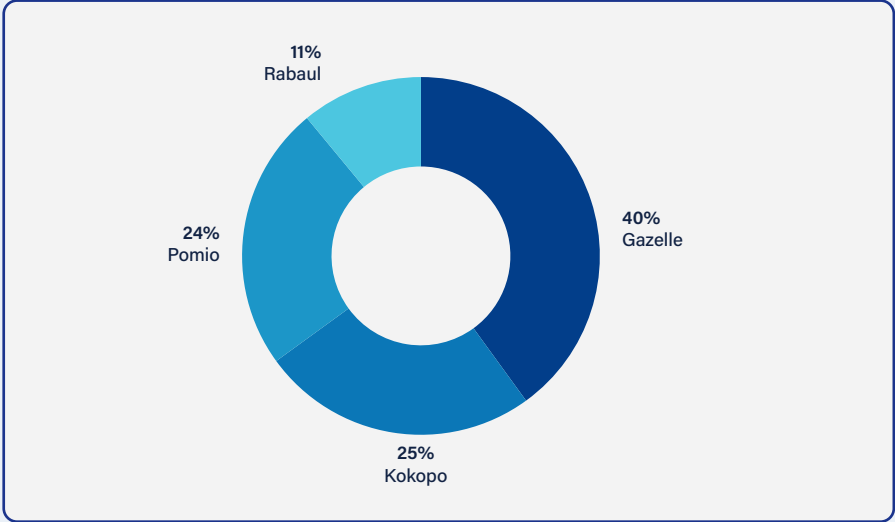
# 18. EAST NEW BRITAIN PROVINCE

Population in brief.

|                  |         |         |
|------------------|---------|---------|
| Total Population | Male    | Female  |
| 434,757          | 226,079 | 208,678 |

|                                        |         |
|----------------------------------------|---------|
| Proportion of PNG's total population   | 4.3%    |
| Annual growth rate since 2011 census   | 2.2%    |
| Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)      | 108     |
| Population density (persons per km²)   | 29      |
| District with highest population count | Gazelle |

## Population Distribution by District



| Districts | Total   | Male   | Female |
|-----------|---------|--------|--------|
| Gazelle   | 174,601 | 90,750 | 83,851 |
| Kokopo    | 106,217 | 54,523 | 51,694 |
| Pomio     | 104,678 | 55,382 | 49,296 |
| Rabaul    | 49,261  | 25,424 | 23,837 |

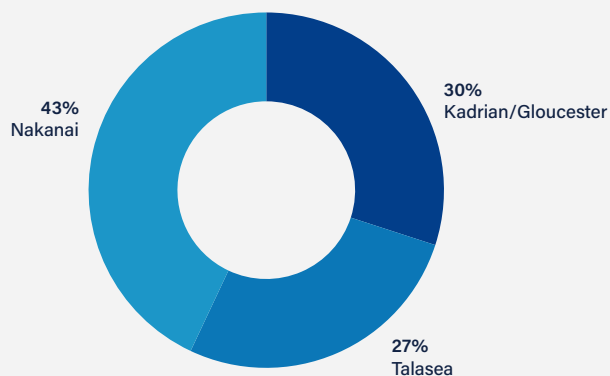
# 19. WEST NEW BRITAIN PROVINCE

Population in brief.

|                  |                |                |
|------------------|----------------|----------------|
| Total Population | Male           | Female         |
| <b>368,643</b>   | <b>195,180</b> | <b>173,463</b> |

|                                                   |         |
|---------------------------------------------------|---------|
| Proportion of PNG's total population              | 3.6%    |
| Annual growth rate since 2011 census              | 2.6%    |
| Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)                 | 113     |
| Population density (persons per km <sup>2</sup> ) | 18      |
| District with highest population count            | Nakanai |

## Population Distribution by District



| Districts           | Total   | Male   | Female |
|---------------------|---------|--------|--------|
| Kandrian/Gloucester | 109,028 | 57,426 | 51,602 |
| Talasea             | 100,085 | 52,815 | 47,270 |
| Nakanai             | 159,530 | 84,939 | 74,591 |

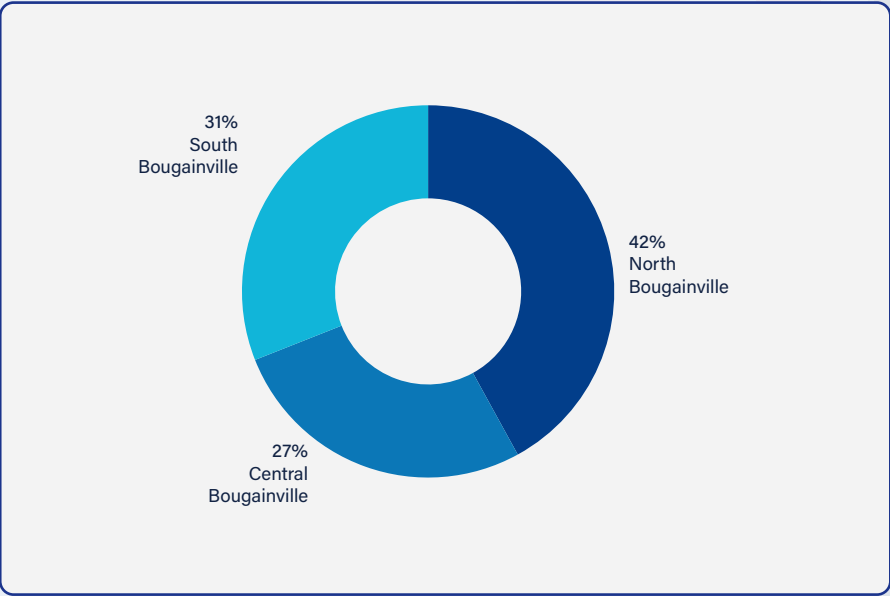
# 20. AUTONOMOUS REGION OF BOUGAINVILLE

Population in brief

|                  |         |         |
|------------------|---------|---------|
| Total Population | Male    | Female  |
| 367,093          | 189,477 | 177,616 |

|                                                   |                    |
|---------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Proportion of PNG's total population              | 3.6%               |
| Annual growth rate since 2011 census              | 3.0%               |
| Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)                 | 107                |
| Population density (persons per km <sup>2</sup> ) | 39                 |
| District with highest population count            | North Bougainville |

## Population Distribution by District



| Districts            | Total   | Male   | Female |
|----------------------|---------|--------|--------|
| North Bougainville   | 153,530 | 78,693 | 74,837 |
| Central Bougainville | 98,067  | 50,934 | 47,133 |
| South Bougainville   | 115,496 | 59,850 | 55,646 |

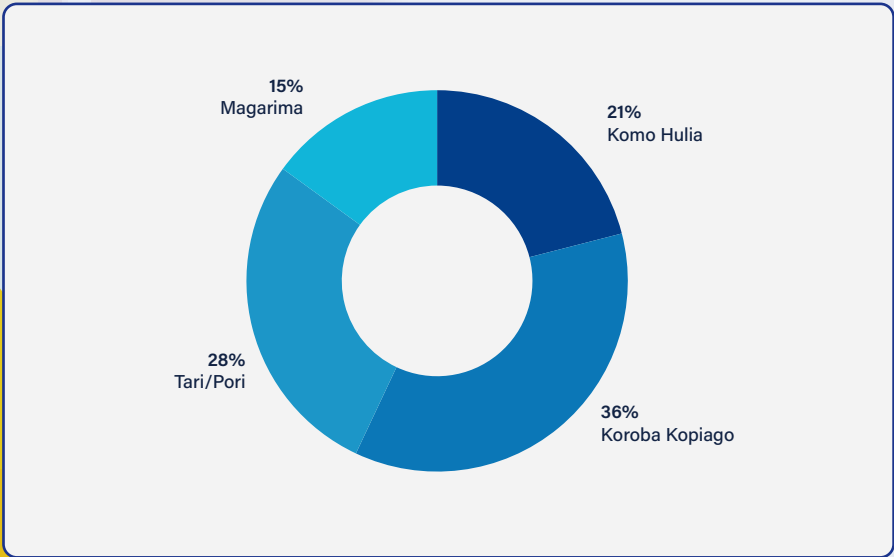
# 21. HELA PROVINCE

## Population in brief

|                  |         |         |
|------------------|---------|---------|
| Total Population | Male    | Female  |
| 365,806          | 194,762 | 171,044 |

|                                        |                |
|----------------------------------------|----------------|
| Proportion of PNG’s total population   | 3.6%           |
| Annual growth rate since 2011 census   | 3.0%           |
| Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)      | 114            |
| Population density (persons per km²)   | 34             |
| District with highest population count | Koroba Kopiago |

### Population Distribution by District



| Districts      | Total   | Male   | Female |
|----------------|---------|--------|--------|
| Komo Hulia     | 77,114  | 41,050 | 36,064 |
| Koroba Kopiago | 130,425 | 69,892 | 60,533 |
| Tari/Pori      | 102,081 | 54,735 | 47,346 |
| Magarima       | 56,186  | 29,085 | 27,101 |

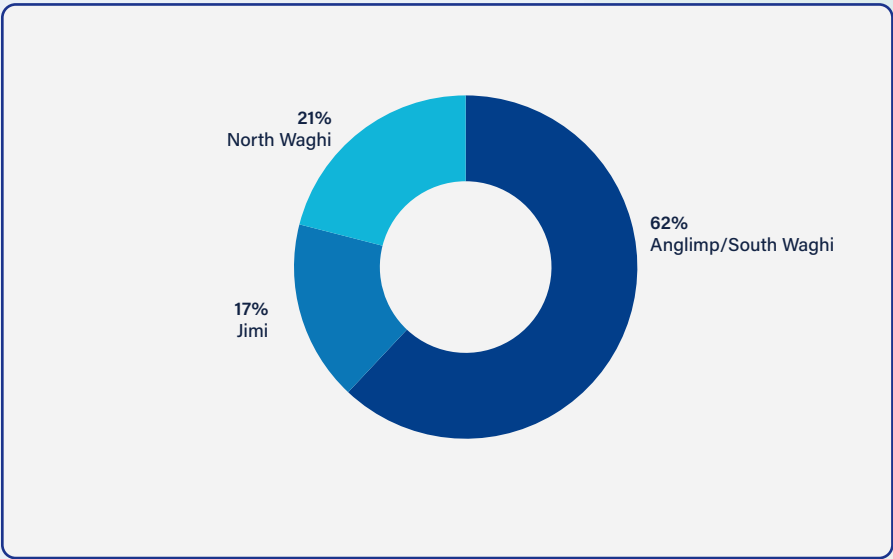
# 22. JIWAKA PROVINCE

Population in brief

|                  |         |         |
|------------------|---------|---------|
| Total Population | Male    | Female  |
| 455,208          | 237,051 | 218,157 |

|                                                   |                       |
|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| Proportion of PNG's total population              | 4.5%                  |
| Annual growth rate since 2011 census              | 2.2%                  |
| Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)                 | 109                   |
| Population density (persons per km <sup>2</sup> ) | 94                    |
| District with highest population count            | Anglimp / South Waghi |

## Population Distribution by District



| Districts           | Total   | Male    | Female  |
|---------------------|---------|---------|---------|
| Anglimp/South Waghi | 281,824 | 146,328 | 135,496 |
| Jimi                | 77,744  | 41,608  | 36,136  |
| North Waghi         | 95,640  | 49,115  | 46,525  |

## 4. GENERAL INFORMATION ON THE 2024 CENSUS

### Introduction

The Papua New Guinea (PNG) National Population Census is the most important national event in the calendar of the country every ten years. In the month of June 2024, the 5th National Population Census was held. The first full census for the country was in 1980, the second in 1990, followed by the third and fourth in 2000 and 2011 respectively.

The importance of the national census cannot be over emphasized. Without accurate population figures, all planning and programs risk being ineffective or futile. The Government of PNG through the National Executive Council (NEC) Decision No. 81/2019 endorsed the need for the conduct of a National Population Census in the year 2020, however due to the global pandemic that affected the country in March 2020, the NEC (Decision No.194/2020) approved to defer the conduct of the census to 2021. Subsequently, another surge of the COVID 19 cases in April 2021 led to further deferment of the census to the most feasible and earlier date being 2024 as endorsed in NEC Decision No. 174/2021.

The Government through the NEC instructed the National Statistical Office (NSO) to conduct the 5th National Population Census in June 2024 with appropriate directions to ministries and departments to help the NSO conduct the census.

### Census Questionnaire

The Census is designed to capture the size of the population, the composition of the population, and the distribution of the population at a fixed point in time, important parameters for development planning.

This information was captured using a census questionnaire comprising of six questions; name, relationship to head of household, sex, age, marital status and citizenship. The 2024 Census questionnaire was endorsed by the National Census Steering Committee (NCSC) with the focus on ensuring the collection of high quality census, instilling confidence in the accuracy and currency of the population count- a key government requirement.

Unlike all previous censuses, the 2024 Census was conducted using the Computer Assisted Personal Interview (CAPI) method using the tablets to collect data from respondents in all geographic sectors.

### Census Operations

The official date for the Census was on 16th June 2024 with counting in most parts of the country conducted from the 17th June 2024 to 31st October 2024. Prolonged duration in some parts of the country was due to many external factors. A total of 22,000 field officers consisting of interviewers and supervisors were trained in May and June 2024 and deployed across the country. As with the previous census, the face to face interview method was used nationwide to collect census data.

Census operations in the provinces was coordinated by 22 provincial census coordinators appointed by respective provincial administrations in 2019. They were trained to coordinate specific census activities as part of the provincial preparations leading up the main census. Their tasks included updating the Census Unit Register, developing provincial budget, facilitating the census recruitment process and coordinating the census publicity drive.

### Census Geography

The census geography is basically a register of all villages, communities, government or mission stations in both urban and rural areas placed under their correct wards, LLGs, districts, and provinces. It is established almost two years before the main census enumeration as a control to ensure everyone living in the country is enumerated on census night, minimizing the chances of double-counting and/or under-counting. It also



helps identify areas not covered. It is also useful for the dissemination of the final census results.

The census covered over 30,000 census units (including villages and communities in urban and rural areas), spanning 22 provinces, 98 districts, 369 LLGs, and more than 6,400 wards.

## **Data Limitatiion**

The report contains population figures based on where people were counted at census time (Sunday 16th June 2024), which may not have been where they usually live. All provinces were visited and successfully counted.

Comparison with other previous censuses should be made with caution because of the differences in the operational strategies and coverage, and definition changes which have been progressively implemented at censuses since 1966.









**CENSUS**  
**2024**

**PAPUA NEW GUINEA**  
NATIONAL POPULATION CENSUS



Pacific  
Community  
Communauté  
du Pacifique

United States  
**Census**  
Bureau

2024 National Population Census Final Figures  
National Statistical Office